



MODERNIZATION

India's cities are bustling, chaotic places where modern, high-rise office blocks stand next to ancient temples, mosques, and monuments. New Delhi is the capital, but Mumbai (Bombay, left) is the biggest. Bangalore is carving out a reputation as the high-tech capital of India and is home to a growing electronics and telecommunications industry. However, much of India is still underdeveloped and many people live below the poverty line.

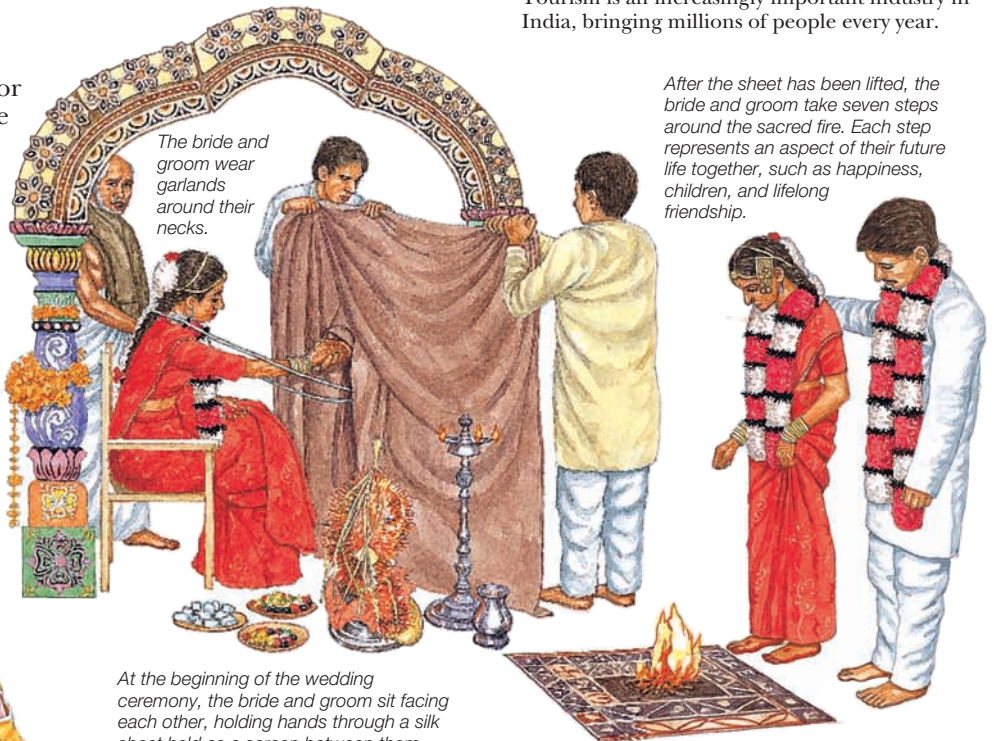


MEMORY IN MARBLE

The Taj Mahal, in Agra, was built in the 17th century by Shah Jahan, one of the Mughal emperors who ruled India from the 16th to the 19th centuries. Built in white marble as a tomb for his beloved wife, it is a fine example of Islamic architecture and attracts many visitors. Tourism is an increasingly important industry in India, bringing millions of people every year.

HINDU WEDDING

Hindu weddings are elaborate affairs, with ceremonies and feasting lasting for several days. Most marriages take place among members of the same *caste*, or social group, and are arranged by the couple's parents. After the wedding, the bride lives with her husband's family. Family life is very important to Hindus. They often live as part of an extended family, with several generations sharing the same house.



SARI

The traditional dress for Indian women is the sari, a length of brightly colored silk or cotton, some 66 ft (20 m) long, which is wrapped around the body and draped over one shoulder. One end of the sari is left hanging or used to cover the head. Traditional dress for men is a *dhoti*, a length of cotton cloth usually wrapped around the waist and between the legs.



OTHER FAITHS

Most people in India are Hindu, but many other faiths are followed, such as Sikhism and Jainism. Sikhs believe in one god. Their holiest shrine is the Golden Temple, in Amritsar. Male Sikhs wear turbans (left), a symbol of purity. Jainism is similar to Hinduism. Jains have respect for all life, and monks wear masks to prevent insects from entering their mouths.

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